Lake Erie Harmful Algal Bloom Bulletin

26 September, 2019, Bulletin 26

Analysis

The *Microcystis* cyanobacteria bloom in the western basin of Lake Erie has declined. Observed conditions (9/23-26) supported mixing of remaining surface concentrations. Recent satellite imagery (9/25) is partially obscured by clouds, but no chlorophyll is visible alongshore Michigan and Ohio coasts. *Microcystis* concentrations are below detectable limits in all samples but one from Maumee Bay. The persistent cyanobacteria bloom in Sandusky Bay continues.

Forecasts

Water temperatures are approaching 68˚F (20˚C), limiting the growth of *Microcystis*. Winds (3-25 kn) forecast today through Monday (9/26-30) will promote mixing and minimize potential transport of remaining surface *Microcystis* concentrations. -Keeney, Jima

Additional Resources

To find a safe place for recreation, visit the Ohio DOH "BeachGuard" site: *http://publicapps.odh.ohio.gov/beachguardpublic/*
Ohio EPA's site on harmful algal blooms: *http://epa.ohio.gov/HAB-Algae*
NOAA's GLERL provides additional HAB data here: *http://www.glerl.noaa.gov/res/HABs_and_Hypoxia*

The images below are "GeoPDF". Please visit https://go.usa.gov/xReTC for instructions on viewing longitude and latitude.

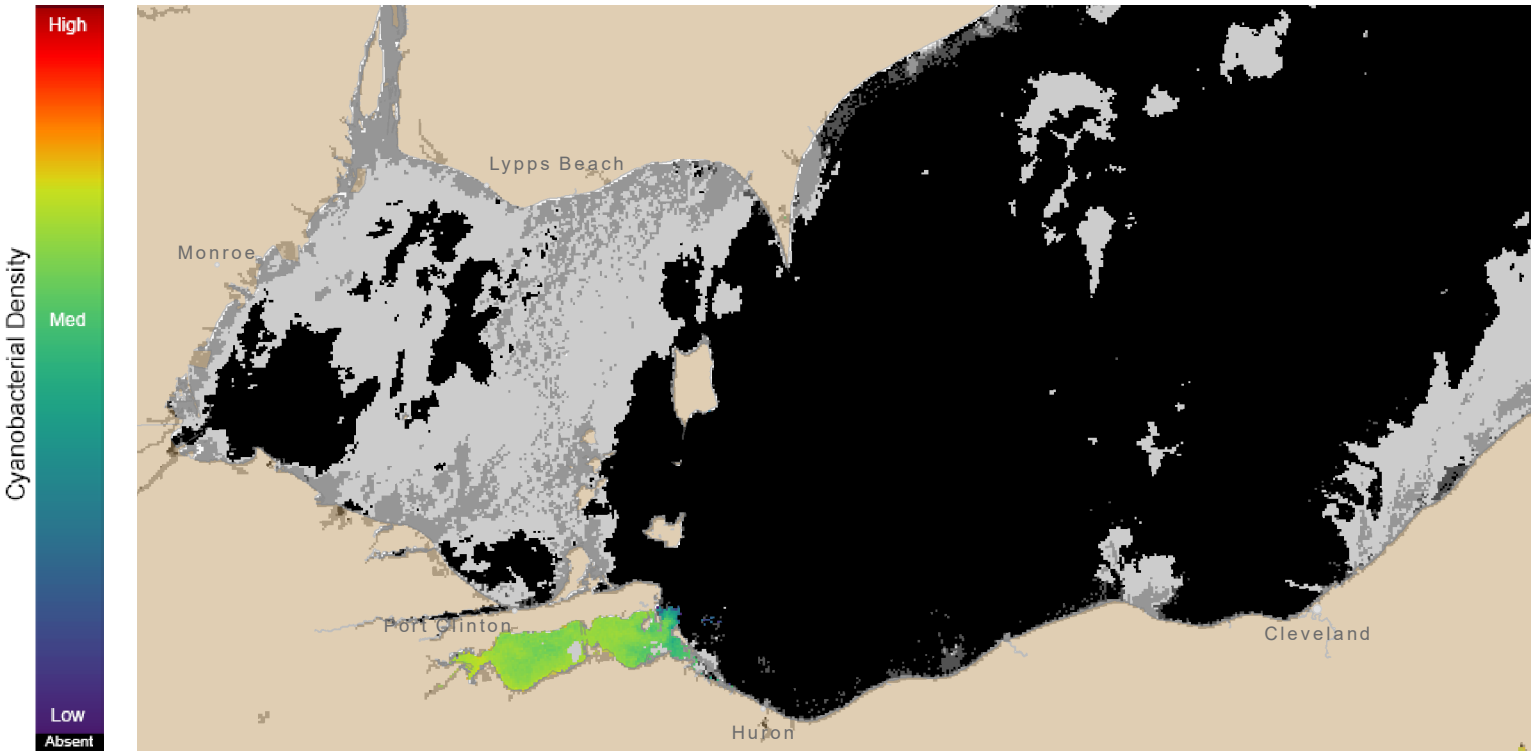
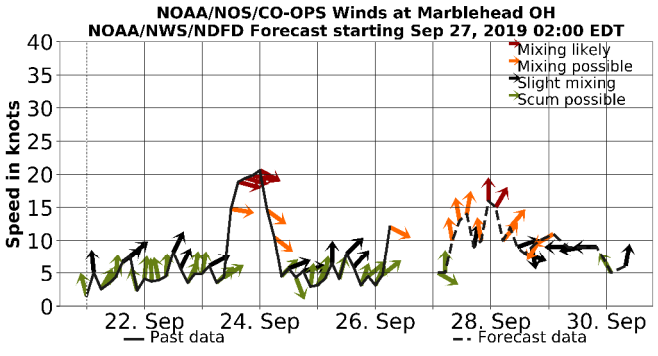
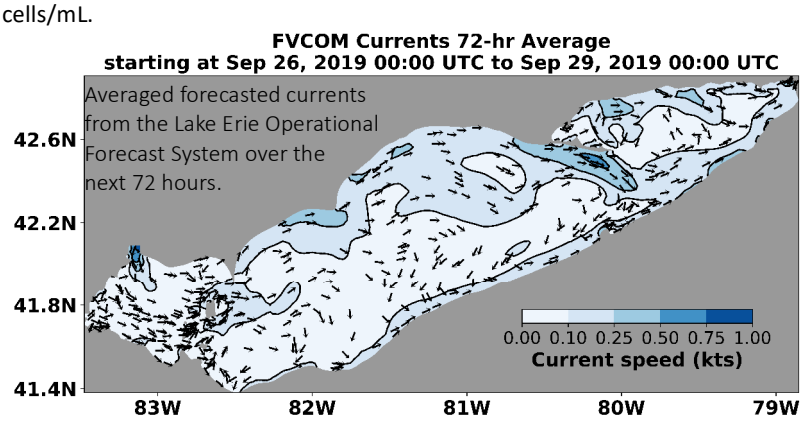


Figure 1. Cyanobacterial Index from modified Copernicus Sentinel 3 data collected 25 September, 2019 at 11:53 EST. Grey indicates clouds or missing data. The estimated threshold for cyanobacteria detection is 20,000 cells/mL.



Wind speed and direction from Marblehead, OH. Blooms mix through the water column at wind speeds greater than 15 knots (or 7.7 m/s).



For more information and to subscribe, please visit the NOAA HAB Foreacst page: https://tidesandcurrents.noaa.gov/hab/lakeerie.html